

Turning casual riders into annual members

A behavioural segmentation · who to convert, and how

Chicago bike-share · 5.84 M rides · Jun 2025 - May 2026 · Executive summary



Casual riders



Annual members

Which casual riders are worth converting?

Cyclistic has two user types — **casual riders** (single / day pass) and **annual members**. Converting the right casual riders is the cheapest growth lever.

- 01 Do casual riders behave differently from members?
- 02 Are casual riders one group — or several distinct profiles?
- 03 Which profiles look most like members, and are big enough to target?

Casual riders are not one audience

Of every ride taken, **36% are casual** — 2.09 M rides in play for conversion.



Inside that casual third sit **three behavioural profiles** — differing in ride length, timing, and how closely they resemble members:

- E-Bike Riders** Short, purposeful, weekday-concentrated — most member-like
- Commute E-Bike Riders** Rush-hour trips, often ending outside a dock
- Classic Leisure Riders** Long weekend rides — furthest from member behaviour

Three profiles, ranked by member similarity

E-Bike Riders

HIGH PRIORITY

52.1%

of casual rides

0.65

member similarity

Short, purposeful trips on weekdays.
Already ride like members.

Commute E-Bike Riders

MEDIUM PRIORITY

17.2%

of casual rides

0.49

member similarity

100% rush-hour rides; ~1 in 4 ends
outside a dock. Infrastructure angle.

Classic Leisure Riders

LOW PRIORITY

30.8%

of casual rides

0.00

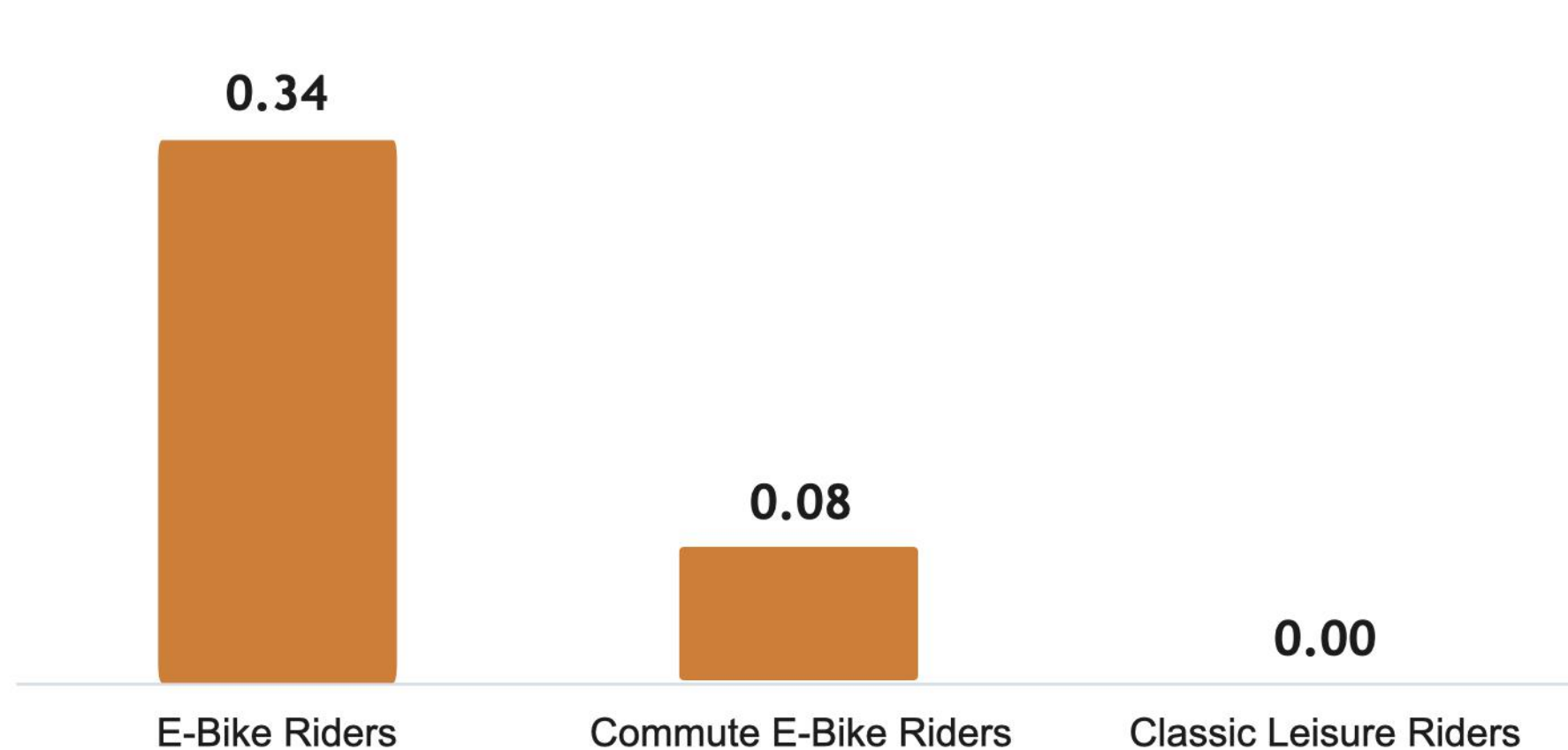
member similarity

Longer recreational rides, weekend-
skewed. A different product fits better.

Member similarity: 1.00 = most member-like. Shown in blue because it measures distance to the member profile.

One segment leads on both size and fit

Priority = member similarity × share of casual rides. **E-Bike Riders win on both dimensions.**



THE TARGET

E-Bike Riders

Largest casual segment (**52%**) and closest to member behaviour (**0.65 similarity**). Size and fit point the same way — a rare, clean targeting call.

Priority score = member similarity × share of casual rides.

Four moves, matched to behaviour

01

Lead with E-Bike Riders

Push the annual membership to this segment first. Message the commute-cost saving vs. pay-per-ride on short weekday e-bike trips.

02

Sell leisure riders a different product

Don't pitch annual membership to Classic Leisure Riders. Offer a weekend or seasonal pass — it matches their long, recreational weekend rides.

03

Test the infrastructure lever

~25% of PM commute e-bike rides end outside docks. Pilot added docking in the residential areas where they end — it may remove a real conversion barrier.

04

Prove it before scaling

Similarity is a structural signal, not a guarantee. Run a controlled A/B campaign on E-Bike Riders and measure real conversion before committing full budget.

The right offer for each segment

SEGMENT	OFFER	CHANNEL SIGNAL	EXPECTATION
 E-Bike Riders	Annual membership	Short weekday e-bike trips	Lead target — scale after test
 Commute E-Bike Riders	Membership + docking pilot	Rush-hour, free-floating ends	Watch — infra may unlock
 Classic Leisure Riders	Weekend / seasonal pass	Long weekend recreational rides	Don't push annual

What this analysis can and cannot say

LIMITATIONS

- Ride-level, not person-level — no user IDs; segments describe behaviour, not individuals.
- Similarity is structural, not a conversion guarantee — price and habit aren't in this data.
- Volume counts rides — frequent riders are over-represented in segment sizes.
- Segments are soft regions, not sharp groups; 'commute' is a proxy for intent.

TO SHARPEN THE NEXT ROUND

- **User IDs**
Segment by person, not by ride
- **Survey data**
Validate intent behind the behaviour
- **Conversion history**
Calibrate similarity against real outcomes

THE DECISION

Run a controlled membership campaign on **E-Bike Riders** — then scale on results.

Largest, most member-like casual segment. Pair the test with a weekend-pass offer for **Classic Leisure Riders** and a docking pilot for **Commute E-Bike Riders**.

■ Casual riders ■ Annual members